

Power of Interest
Equality Diversity and Inclusion Policy

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Approved by: Alison Zhao

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Power of Interest (POI) is committed to encouraging equality, diversity and inclusion among our organisation, and eliminating unlawful discrimination. The aim is for our workforce to be truly representative of all sections of society and our customers, and for each employee to feel respected and able to give their best. The organisation - in providing goods and/or services and/or facilities - is also committed against unlawful discrimination of customers or the public.

POI believes that debating should be accessible to everyone regardless of background, identity or personal circumstances. We are committed to creating an environment where everyone feels welcome, respected and able to participate fully.

POI supports freedom of expression within the law. Participants are encouraged to explore differing viewpoints respectfully. Expressing a lawful opinion in the context of a structured debate will not in itself constitute discrimination or harassment. However, discriminatory conduct, targeted abuse, intimidation or behaviour that creates an unsafe environment will not be tolerated.

This policy applies to all Directors, employees, volunteers, members, participants, parents, contractors and anyone representing or participating in the activities of Power of Interest.

Our policy's purpose

This policy's purpose is to:

1. Provide equality, fairness and respect for all in our employment, whether temporary, part-time or full-time
2. Not unlawfully discriminate because of the Equality Act 2010 protected characteristics of:
 - age
 - disability
 - gender reassignment
 - marriage and civil partnership
 - pregnancy and maternity
 - race (including colour, nationality, and ethnic or national origin)
 - religion or belief
 - sex
 - sexual orientation
3. Oppose and avoid all forms of unlawful discrimination. This includes in:
 - dealing with grievances and discipline
 - selection for employment, promotion, training or other developmental opportunities

Our commitments

The organisation commits to:

1. Encourage equality, diversity and inclusion in the workplace as they are good practice and good organisational practice
2. Create an environment free of bullying, harassment, victimisation and unlawful discrimination, and where individual differences and the contributions of all Directors, volunteers, employees, participants and visitors are recognised and valued. Bullying, harassment, victimisation or discrimination by any Director, volunteer, employee, participant or visitor will be taken seriously and may result in appropriate action, including removal from activities or termination of the individual's role.
4. Make opportunities for training, development and progress available to all participants, who will be helped and encouraged to develop their full potential, so their talents and resources can be fully utilised to maximise the efficiency of the organisation.
5. Make decisions concerning staff being based on merit (apart from in any necessary and limited exemptions and exceptions allowed under the Equality Act).
6. Review employment practices and procedures when necessary to ensure fairness, and also update them and the policy to take account of changes in the law.
7. The Board will periodically review participation, recruitment and feedback to identify opportunities to improve equality, diversity and inclusion.

Agreement to follow this policy

The equality, diversity and inclusion policy is fully supported by the Board of Directors and has been agreed with employees.

Our disciplinary and grievance procedures

Details of the organisation's grievance and disciplinary policies and procedures can be found at the organisation website [poi.org.uk]. This includes with whom anybody should raise a complaint with.

Anyone who believes they have experienced discrimination or harassment may raise the matter under the Complaints Policy, Grievance Policy or Safeguarding Policy, as appropriate.